



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kings Academy Christian Schools
School Website: <https://kacs.net/>

December 23, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Kings Academy Christian School (Tyler, TX) presents a strongly Christian, parent-partnered University-Model approach. The public materials emphasize Christ-centered formation, discipleship, prayer, worship, Bible study, and close parental involvement in education. While these features anchor Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) as CLASSICAL, other core elements of the classical rubric—most notably Curriculum and Pedagogy rooted in liberal arts, Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and Socratic/Scholé traditions—are not explicitly documented in the publicly available materials. The result is a classification that is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with clear strengths in religious foundations and parent-community partnership but notable gaps in explicitly classical curriculum and pedagogy design.

Key strengths - Religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly articulated: biblically-based, Christ-centered life, theology-infused practice, prayer, Bible study, and discipleship. This is reinforced by explicit statements about "discipleship-based education" and a Christ-centered formation of students.

- Strong parents-and-community emphasis: explicit partnership with families, parent formation, and training; parental involvement touted as a central factor in student success.
- The school publicly frames itself as a K–12 University-Model school actively partnering with families to educate Christ-centered students, with two campuses and intentional family-teacher collaboration.

Key gaps - Curriculum and pedagogy are not explicitly aligned with classical liberal arts criteria (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; classical history scope; memory work; chanting; scholé; etc.). Public materials emphasize the University-Model structure and parental involvement rather than a doctrinally explicit classical curriculum. This reduces the strength of Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) below CLASSICAL levels. - Little explicit reference to Great Books, liberal arts canon, or explicit Socratic/seminar-based upper-school pedagogy in the public materials. This further weakens Element 3 and Element 4 relative to a full classical rubric.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Explicitly adopt and publish a classical-core curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) aligned with liberal arts canon (Great Books selections or a robust Great Conversation program).

- Introduce and document explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars in more grades, memory work, recitation, and Paideia-style seminars at appropriate levels).
- Add classical-language components (Latin or Greek sequence) and historically grounded content (Western civilization/history through a classical lens) to strengthen the Curriculum category.
- Enhance the internal living-curriculum narrative with a formal teacher-profiles-and-competencies framework that mirrors the "living curriculum" ideal in classical education.
- Extend parent formation with structured classical literature/book-group offerings, and clearly articulate how parent-teacher collaboration advances a classical telos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize biblically-based, Christian faith, and Christ-centered formation, including references to discipleship and God-centered life. Examples include “biblically-based, parentally-guided, Christian faith and a sound, teacher-directed, academic environment” and “equipping students for a Christ-centered life.”

- Worship, prayer, and Bible study are noted as part of the curriculum and school life. - The school positions its mission around partnering with families to form students in faith and values.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: biblically-based, Christ-centered, God/Bible, prayer, worship, Bible study, discipleship, theology (implied in framed Christian education), Christian faith, Christ-centered life. Estimated positives: 7–9 distinct items. - Negative indicators: virtually none in the public materials (no explicit secular or relativistic signals).

Why this rating - The material clearly centers religious and metaphysical aims, with explicit language about truth/faith commitments, sacred activities, and a discipleship-oriented approach. This aligns strongly with Classical expectations in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category, yielding CLASSICAL. Citations show explicit themes (biblically-based, Christ-centered life, prayer, worship, Bible study, discipleship).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation and discipleship within a Christ-centered framework, and frames education around passing on beliefs and values, rather than solely job preparation. Public statements include “partnering with families to equip students for a Christ-centered life” and the formation-focused language around family involvement and character formation. - The explicit “University-Model School” model emphasizes formation and partnership with families, rather than a conventional “workforce” preparation narrative. - The formal goal of education as formation in virtue is implied through discipleship and moral/spiritual development, even if not phrased as a direct Great-Books telos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, Christ-centered life, discipleship, moral/spiritual development, partnership with families. - Negative indicators: explicit phrases like “workforce preparation” or “21st century skills” are not present; however, the absence of explicit classical telos language (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty as real, Great Conversation) lowers the score from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Quantitative sense: 3–4 clear positive terms; 0 clear negative terms.

Why this rating - Strong formation/disciple-making orientation meets several Positive keyword indicators but lacks explicit classical telos-language (true/good/beautiful) and Great-Conversation framing. The overall emphasis is religious formation and parental partnership rather than a full classical-pedagogical telos. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Citations illustrate formation and Christ-centered aims and family-partner framing.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curricular framing centers on the University-Model approach and parental/teacher collaboration, with references to curriculum lists and an emphasis on a Christ-centered, home-involved model rather than explicit classical liberal-arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books. Public materials show curriculum lists and the UMS framework rather than a classical curriculum, e.g., “King’s Academy uses a university style schedule” and “The University-Model School concept... molds them into one model.” - There is emphasis on faith-integrated content, but not explicit Great Books or Trivium components. The publicly documented curriculum content centers on structure and faith integration rather than classical liberal-arts cannon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators explicitly tied to classical curriculum (Great Books, trivium, liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric) are not present in the public-facing curriculum content. - Nega-

tive indicators: No explicit “STEM-first” or social-studies-as-history shifts are evidenced; however, absence of classical-canon language is the main negative signal for this category.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit classical curriculum elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; liberal arts canon) places Curriculum squarely in NOT CLASSICAL. Public pages emphasize the University-Model and faith integration rather than a classical liberal-arts sequence. Citations show the University-Model framing and curriculum-lists emphasis rather than classical core.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The University-Model approach is described as a hybrid model with significant parental involvement and alternating home-school days, which is not aligned with the classical pedagogy model (Socratic seminars, Paideia, melodic memory work, etc.). Public materials emphasize parental-guided, teacher-directed structure rather than a classical pedagogy (e.g., “university model,” “parents as co-teachers” and home days). - There is no explicit public documentation of Socratic seminars, rigorous rhetoric training, or upper-school seminars/debates; rather, the high-school pedagogy appears to be traditional teacher-directed with student-home integration.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators for classical pedagogy (Socratic, scholé, memory work, chanting, recitation, narrations, seminar-based learning) are not evidenced in the public materials. - Negative indicators: absence of explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy and absence of memory-based or chant-based practices in the public-facing content.

Why this rating - The absence of classic pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, Paideia-style instruction, memory work, chanting, or scholé days) yields NOT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy. The University-Model model’s emphasis on parental involvement and a hybrid schedule is not aligned with the classical pedagogy described in the Six Essential Elements. Citations illustrate the University-Model and home-day structure.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described in terms of administrators, classroom teachers, and staff, with a focus on leadership roles (Head of School, Upper/Lower Campus Principals, Directors). There is no explicit language about the faculty as “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as mentors who model virtue” in the public materials. The materials emphasize roles and relationships but not a classical-faculty philosophy. - There is inflected emphasis on discipleship, faith-saturated leadership, and partnership with families, which, while positive, does not align with classical “living curriculum” or teacher-mentorship pedagogy language from the classical lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: presence of teachers and leaders who are described in faith-based and professional terms. - Negative indicators: absence of explicit classical-faculty descriptors (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as mentors who model virtue”).

Why this rating - Given the lack of explicit classical-faculty language and living curriculum framing, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL. The visible structure is administrative and faith-centered rather than a classical-faculty model. Citations show administrator and faculty roles described publicly.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames itself as a partner with families and as a co-teaching model, with explicit statements about parental involvement as central to student success. Phrases include “partnering with families to equip students for a Christ-centered life” and “The single most influential factor in a child’s educational performance is an involved parent.” There is also explicit mention of parental training and teaching responsibilities within the University-Model framework.

- The school communicates opportunities for parents to be engaged, train to understand methods, and participate in school life (e.g., admissions, events, and family involvement language). - There are references to parent formation and classical-book-group-like engagement in the broader classical-literature context (e.g.,

“Why We Do What We Do” and “Why King’s?”; book-and-family-oriented engagement is implied through emphasis on discipleship and partnership).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with families, co-teaching, parental primacy, parent formation, open campus/visits (implied by openness to parental involvement), and explicit statements around parent involvement as transformative in education. Estimated positives: 5–6 distinct items (parity with classical-community signals). - Negative indicators: none identified in public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The frequency and clarity of parent engagement and partnership signals align strongly with classical-education expectations for Parents & Community, yielding CLASSICAL. Citations show direct statements about parental involvement and “involved parent” language.

What Would Move the Needle

- If you want to elevate Kings Academy to FULLY CLASSICAL, publicly and clearly integrate and publish:
 - A classical core curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit Great Books selections or a robust Great Conversation program.
 - A documented classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars across more grade levels, Paideia-style discussions, memory work, recitation).
 - A visible commitment to classical languages (Latin or Greek) and to the study of Western civilization through classical channels.
 - A formalized “living curriculum” narrative for the faculty, with teacher portraits and teacher-training paths aligned to classical pedagogy.
 - A public-facing articulation of history content with a classical lens (chronology, Western civilization, moral philosophy) integrated across grades.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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